

find the cheapest plan (although you should do that), but to find ways to cut down repetitive costs by doing work upfront. And one of the effective ways to do that is to call the customer care and ask them to lower your bills.

I've worked in customer care centers and have enough friends in these roles wherein the guys taught me the tools of the trade. Using them, I've cut down my TataSky bills from 800 to 450 per month, reduced Vodafone's postpaid bills by 40% and got my yearly credit card fee waived.

When you give them directives (*"I'd like to have this waived"*) and not propositions (*"Can you please do something? or Are you sure?"*), they'll knock down fees. Being polite and smiling in the conversation while staying firm is better at yielding results.

For credit card negotiations, it is better to be firm handed. But when you call in to cut down on Dish or Wifi charges, follow the opposite. Get them on your side and let them empathize with you. They have people barking into their ears all-day and following the opposite route gets you higher success rates. Before you make the call, make sure to do your homework on the company's offerings to new customers (which is usually better than your plan) and similar deals by their competitors. When you call them, appreciate their quality service and show gratitude.

You: *"Hi George, I'm sorry, I'm almost embarrassed to make this call. I love your service and its total value for money. (Go on for another 2 lines about how the service you experience is). It's worth every paisa I pay and that's why I feel bad to ask even more"* <be silent>

Rep: *"Yes sir tell me what I can do for you?"* (BAM! First big win: he feels he owes you something because he's connected with you. If you bark or demand, they will play hardball as usual)

You: *"George, this is going to sound harsh. But I feel I'm such a loyal customer, always pay my bills and am a great ambassador for your service. In that scenario, do you think it is fair that you guys are offering better rates to someone who just joined you from the street?"* <BIG PAUSE, totally shut up, even if it takes eons, let the rep speak first>

Rep: *"I do think what you're asking is reasonable. Let me knock down those charges. You'll get a month free for your loyalty"*